



Triennial Actuarial Valuation 2024

University of Reading Pension Scheme

Sponsor Employer	University of Reading
Scheme Actuary	Hymans Robertson
Valuation Date	31/03/2024
Document Status	Final - approved by Trustee
Document Classification	Confidential - BPA Review
Prepared For	Royal London BPA Origination

1. Executive Summary

This report sets out the actuarial valuation of the University of Reading Pension Scheme as at 31 March 2024. The scheme is a defined benefit - final salary (closed) established by University of Reading and is currently closed to new entrants (2011) and future accrual (2016). The valuation has been prepared in accordance with the Pensions Act 2004, the Scheme Funding Regulations 2005, and the Trustee's Statement of Funding Principles.

As at the valuation date, the scheme held assets of GBP 84.1m against technical provisions of GBP 88.5m, giving a funding level of 95.2% and a deficit of GBP 4.4m. The Trustee has considered the scheme's long-term objective of securing member benefits through a buy-out transaction, and this document forms part of the wider BPA origination pack being prepared for Royal London.

Technical Provisions	GBP 88.5m
Scheme Assets	GBP 84.1m
Funding Deficit	GBP 4.4m
Funding Level	95.2%
Total Membership	604
Indicative BPA Premium	GBP 90.2m

2. Scheme Information

Scheme Name	University of Reading Pension Scheme
Sponsor Employer	University of Reading
Sector	Higher Education
Scheme Type	Defined Benefit - Final Salary (Closed)
Scheme Status	Closed to new entrants (2011) and future accrual (2016)
Trustee	University of Reading Pension Trustee Limited
Scheme Actuary	Hymans Robertson
Administrator	Barnett Waddingham
Investment Manager	Schroders
Normal Retirement Age	65
Accrual Rate	1/80th of Final Pensionable Salary per year of service
Revaluation in Deferment	Statutory (CPI capped at 2.5% p.a.)
Indexation in Payment	CPI capped at 5% p.a.
Spouse's Pension	50% of member's pension

3. Membership Summary

Category	Count	% of Total	Average Age
Active Members	0	0.0%	52.4
Deferred Members	293	48.5%	56.8
Pensioner Members	311	51.5%	73.2
Total Membership	604	100.0%	63.7

Member data has been supplied by the Administrator as at the valuation date and has been subject to the standard data quality checks described in Appendix A. No material data issues were identified that would affect the valuation results. Average ages are weighted by liability.

3.1 Pensioner Age Profile

Age Band	Members	Average Pension (GBP p.a.)
60-64	24	14,820
65-69	55	13,210
70-74	74	12,640
75-79	68	11,480
80-84	49	10,120
85+	37	8,940

4. Funding Position

The funding position has been calculated on the Technical Provisions basis agreed between the Trustee and Sponsor. A separate buy-out basis has been prepared for the BPA transaction pack.

Measure	As at 31/03/2021	As at 31/03/2024
Technical Provisions (GBP m)	83.2	88.5
Scheme Assets (GBP m)	76.5	84.1
Surplus / (Deficit) (GBP m)	-6.7	-4.4
Funding Level	92.0%	95.2%

4.1 Buy-out Basis

Estimated buy-out liability	GBP 101.8m
Estimated buy-out funding level	82.6%
Additional premium vs TP	GBP 13.3m

5. Actuarial Assumptions

The assumptions below have been set by the Trustee having regard to advice from the Scheme Actuary and following consultation with the Sponsor.

Discount Rate (pre-retirement)	Gilts + 1.66% p.a.
Discount Rate (post-retirement)	Gilts + 1.06% p.a.
RPI Inflation	3.64% p.a.
CPI Inflation	4.50% p.a.
Salary Increase (active)	CPI + 1.0% p.a.
Pension Increase (LPI 5%)	4.50% p.a.
Pension Increase (LPI 2.5%)	2.50% p.a.
Base Mortality Table	S3PMA / S3PFA
Mortality Improvements	CMI_2023 with 1.25% long-term rate
Commutation Take-up	80% of maximum tax-free cash
Proportion Married	85% (males), 70% (females)

6. Asset Allocation

The scheme's strategic asset allocation at 31/03/2024 is set out below.

Asset Class	Allocation (%)	Value (GBP m)
Liability-Driven Investment (LDI)	54.3%	45.5
Buy-and-Maintain Credit	23.2%	19.4
Global Equities	8.5%	7.1
Property / Real Assets	7.2%	6.0
Cash & Collateral	7.2%	6.0
Total	100.4%	84.1

The Trustee continues to run a high-hedging LDI strategy, with an estimated hedge ratio of 95% on interest rates and 93% on inflation, measured against the technical provisions liabilities. The Investment Manager, Schroders, reports quarterly against the Statement of Investment Principles.

7. Projected Benefit Cashflows

The table below shows the expected benefit outgo over the next 10 years based on the valuation assumptions. Figures are nominal GBP m.

Year	Pensions in Payment	Lump Sums	Transfers Out	Total
2025	3.4	0.4	0.2	4.2
2026	3.5	0.3	0.1	4.0
2027	3.6	0.3	0.1	4.1
2028	3.9	0.4	0.2	4.3
2029	3.5	0.3	0.2	4.4
2030	3.9	0.4	0.2	4.5
2031	3.8	0.4	0.2	4.2
2032	3.8	0.4	0.1	4.3
2033	3.9	0.3	0.2	4.5
2034	4.1	0.3	0.1	4.5

8. Employer Covenant

The Trustee has obtained an independent assessment of the University of Reading covenant from a specialist adviser. The covenant is assessed as tending to Strong on the Pensions Regulator's four-point scale, reflecting the sponsor's balance sheet strength, predictable cashflows and continued engagement with the scheme. The Trustee reviews the covenant at least annually.

8.1 Recovery Plan

Deficit Reduction Contribution	GBP 1.4m per annum until 31/07/2028
Recovery Plan End Date	31/07/2028
PPF Annual Levy	GBP 68,200
Expense Reserve	GBP 185,000 p.a.

The Trustee and Sponsor have agreed to accelerate the recovery plan in the event of a successful BPA transaction, with residual deficit contributions continuing at 50% of the current rate until wind-up is complete.

9. BPA Transaction Profile

Transaction Type	Pensioner Buy-in (Phase 1)
Target Completion	Q3/Q4 2025
Indicative Premium (pensioner tranche)	GBP 49.6m
Indicative Premium (deferred tranche)	GBP 40.6m
Total Indicative Premium	GBP 90.2m
Expected Insurer Price Lock	30 days from exclusivity

Appendix A - Data Quality

Member data was supplied by the Administrator in standard CSV format. Standard checks have been performed on dates of birth, pension amounts, commencement dates and spouse data. No material issues were identified that would affect the valuation results.

Appendix B - GMP Equalisation

The scheme has completed GMP equalisation in respect of service between 17 May 1990 and 5 April 1997 following the High Court's Lloyds Banking Group judgment. Residual conversion work is ongoing in advance of buy-out.